

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7)

Chapter 1: वन्दे भारतमातरम् (Vande Bharatamataram)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	1 — वन्दे भारतमातरम् (Vande Bharatamataram)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Questions test comprehension of the lesson's meaning, theme and grammar. Watch the classic traps: वन्दे takes its object in the ACCUSATIVE (वन्दे मातरम्, not वन्दे माता or मातरः); वन्दे means 'I salute/bow', NOT 'I love'; vowel length (ह्रस्व/दीर्घ) changes meaning (आनन्द vs अनन्द); and Sanskrit compounds (देशभक्तः vs धर्मभक्तः) are read by splitting their members. Sanskrit is quoted in Devanagari; choose the best English meaning or grammatical answer. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

- What does the phrase वन्दे मातरम् (Vande Mataram) mean?
(A) The Mother loves me (B) Mothers of the nation
(C) I bow to / salute the Mother (D) Salute, O mothers!
- The verb वन्दे most precisely means:
(A) I salute / I bow / I praise (B) I love (romantically)
(C) I see (D) I give
- Translating वन्दे as 'I love' is wrong because:
(A) वन्दे actually means 'I hate' (B) वन्दे has no meaning at all
(C) love and salutation are the same word in Sanskrit
(D) Sanskrit uses different verbs for love (e.g. कामये) and for salutation (वन्दे)
- In वन्दे मातरम्, the word मातरम् is in which case?
(A) nominative (the subject) (B) genitive (possession)
(C) accusative (the object being saluted) (D) vocative (direct address)
- 'I bow to the Mother' requires मातरम् rather than माता because:
(A) माता is a plural form (B) मातरम् is the subject doing the bowing
(C) the Mother is the object of वन्दे, which takes the accusative
(D) माता means 'ocean'

6. Who wrote the song 'Vande Mataram'?

- | | |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------|
| (A) Rabindranath Tagore | (B) the two children in the lesson |
| (C) the farmers of Bharat | (D) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay |

7. The novel in which 'Vande Mataram' appears is:

- | | |
|------------------|---------------------------|
| (A) गीतगोविन्दम् | (B) आनन्दमठः (Anandamath) |
| (C) रघुवंशम् | (D) मेघदूतम् |

8. The chapter dates the novel आनन्दमठः to:

- | | |
|----------|----------------------|
| (A) 1947 | (B) 1882 |
| (C) 1950 | (D) the 12th century |

9. An उपन्यासः is a:

- | | |
|--------------|-----------|
| (A) song | (B) novel |
| (C) mountain | (D) ocean |

10. In the lesson, what prompts the mother to explain the song?

- | | |
|---|----------------------------|
| (A) a school examination | (B) a festival celebration |
| (C) the children's जिज्ञासा (curiosity) about its meaning | |
| (D) a farmer's request | |

11. जिज्ञासा means:

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-----------|
| (A) salutation | (B) novel |
| (C) curiosity / desire to know | (D) sweat |

12. Which form is CORRECT for 'I salute the Mother'?

- | | |
|-----------------|------------------|
| (A) वन्दे माता | (B) वन्दे मातरम् |
| (C) वन्दे मातरः | (D) वन्दे मातृ |

13. मातरः would be wrong in this song because it is:

- | | |
|---|-----------------------------|
| (A) nominative plural ('mothers'), not the accusative singular needed | |
| (B) the correct accusative singular | (C) a verb meaning 'salute' |
| (D) the genitive of 'ocean' | |

14. The words नमः and वन्दे both take their object in the:

- | | |
|---------------------|-------------------|
| (A) nominative case | (B) vocative case |
| (C) accusative case | (D) locative case |

15. If a student writes वन्दे माता, the error is that माता is:

- | | |
|---|------------|
| (A) accusative singular, which is correct | |
| (B) nominative singular, but the object of वन्दे must be accusative | |
| (C) a plural form | (D) a verb |

16. The stem मातृ becomes _____ in the accusative singular.

- (A) माता (B) मातरः
(C) मातरम् (D) मात्रा

17. पर्वतराजः ('king of mountains') refers in the poem to:

- (A) the Himalaya (B) the ocean
(C) a farmer (D) a holy place

18. पर्वतराजः literally breaks down as:

- (A) 'river' + 'king'
(B) पर्वत ('mountain') + राजः ('king') = 'king of mountains'
(C) 'mountain' + 'ocean' (D) 'king' + 'curiosity'

19. The poem describes the Himalaya as crowning Bharat 'as a crown' (मुकुटरूपेण), so the Himalaya is imagined at Bharat's:

- (A) head / top (north) (B) feet (south)
(C) left hand (D) back

20. Calling the Himalaya पर्वतराजः is an example of:

- (A) a grammatical error
(B) poetic praise giving the greatest mountain a royal title
(C) a farmer's tool (D) the name of the novel

21. रत्नाकरः ('mine of jewels') in the poem refers to:

- (A) the Himalaya (B) a holy place
(C) a crop field (D) the ocean

22. In समुद्रः ... चरणौ प्रक्षालयति ('the ocean washes the feet'), whose feet are washed?

- (A) the Motherland's (भारतमातुः) (B) the farmers'
(C) the children's (D) Bankim Chandra's

23. In भारतमातुः चरणौ ('the Motherland's feet'), भारतमातुः is in the _____ case.

- (A) genitive (possession) (B) accusative
(C) instrumental (D) vocative

24. The image of the ocean washing Bharat's feet while the Himalaya crowns her head presents Bharat as:

- (A) a small village
(B) a revered mother, honoured from head to foot
(C) a single farmer (D) a foreign land

25. तीर्थक्षेत्राणि means:

- (A) ocean waves (B) mountain peaks
(C) novels (D) holy places / places of pilgrimage

26. Mentioning तीर्थक्षेत्राणि in praise of Bharat highlights the land's:

- (A) sacredness (B) poverty
(C) small size (D) lack of rivers

27. सस्यश्यामला describes Bharat as:

- (A) white with snow (B) dry as a desert
(C) blue like the sea (D) green/dark with crops

28. सस्यश्यामला breaks into सस्य + श्यामला, meaning:

- (A) 'crops' + 'dark/green' = dark-green with crops
(B) 'snow' + 'white' (C) 'ocean' + 'blue'
(D) 'mountain' + 'tall'

29. Describing Bharat as सस्यश्यामला praises her:

- (A) barren deserts (B) frozen mountains
(C) empty oceans (D) fertile, crop-rich farmland

30. कृषकबान्धवा: means:

- (A) the soldiers (B) the farmers (literally 'farmer-brethren')
(C) the kings (D) the merchants

31. According to the poem, the farmers water Bharat's soil with:

- (A) drops of rain only (B) ocean water
(C) melted snow (D) their drops of sweat (स्वेदबिन्दुभिः)

32. In स्वेदबिन्दुभिः सिञ्चन्ति ('they water with sweat-drops'), स्वेदबिन्दुभिः is in the ____ case.

- (A) accusative (the object) (B) genitive (possession)
(C) instrumental (the means, 'with/by') (D) nominative (the subject)

33. The instrumental ending -भिः in स्वेदबिन्दुभिः signals the meaning:

- (A) 'with / by means of' (the drops) (B) 'to / for' the drops
(C) 'of' the drops (D) 'O drops!'

34. Honouring कृषकबान्धवा: who water the land with their sweat shows the poem's respect for:

- (A) wealthy traders (B) foreign rulers
(C) the hard work of farmers (D) the ocean alone

35. देशभक्तः means:

- (A) one devoted to duty (B) patriot (one devoted to the country)
(C) a farmer (D) a novelist

36. The difference between देशभक्तः and धर्मभक्तः lies in the:

- (A) second member भक्तः, which differs (B) verb ending
(C) first member - देश ('country') vs धर्म ('duty/righteousness')
(D) vowel length only

37. धर्मभक्तः would best describe someone devoted to:
(A) the country (देश) (B) the ocean
(C) duty / righteousness (धर्म) (D) farming
38. Sanskrit compounds like देशभक्तः are best understood by:
(A) ignoring the first member (B) guessing from English
(C) reading them backwards letter by letter
(D) splitting them into their members and reading each part
39. In आनन्दमठः, the first syllable has a long आ. Shortening it to अ would be wrong because:
(A) vowel length (ह्रस्व/दीर्घ) changes meaning in Sanskrit
(B) long and short vowels mean the same thing (C) Sanskrit has no long vowels
(D) अ is always longer than आ
40. आ (as in आनन्द) is a _____ vowel, while अ is a _____ vowel.
(A) short ... long (B) silent ... loud
(C) long (दीर्घ) ... short (ह्रस्व) (D) nasal ... oral
41. आनन्द means 'bliss'. This shows that mispronouncing the आ:
(A) never matters in Sanskrit (B) makes the word plural
(C) turns it into a verb
(D) could change or destroy the word's meaning
42. The short/long (ह्रस्व/दीर्घ) vowel distinction is studied in detail in which chapter?
(A) Chapter 1 (B) Chapter 14 (declensions)
(C) Chapter 13 (वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः) (D) Chapter 15 (conjugations)
43. The root of वन्दे is:
(A) कम् ('to love') (B) वन्द् ('to salute/praise')
(C) दृश् ('to see') (D) गम् ('to go')
44. वन्दे is in the _____ person, _____ number.
(A) third person, plural ('they') (B) first person, singular ('I')
(C) second person, singular ('you') (D) first person, plural ('we')
45. To say 'I love the Mother' (not salute), Sanskrit would use a verb like:
(A) कामये / स्निह्यामि, not वन्दे (B) वन्दे, which means love
(C) नमः, which means love (D) सिञ्चन्ति, which means love
46. The best one-line sense of वन्दे मातरम् is:
(A) 'The mothers salute me.' (B) 'O Mother, come here.'
(C) 'I offer salutation to the Mother (Motherland).'
47. In the lesson, the Motherland (भारतमाता) is portrayed as:

- (A) a fierce enemy (B) an ordinary farmer
(C) a foreign queen (D) a loving mother to be revered

48. Which set of images does the poem use to praise Bharat?

- (A) Himalaya as crown, ocean washing her feet, fields green with crops
(B) skyscrapers, factories and cars (C) deserts, storms and ruins
(D) foreign kings and armies

49. The overall theme of 'Vande Mataram' in this lesson is:

- (A) loving reverence for the Motherland and her natural beauty
(B) a lesson on cooking (C) a guide to trade
(D) a list of grammar rules only

50. कस्याः चरणौ समुद्रः प्रक्षालयति? The answer भारतमातुः is genitive because it expresses:

- (A) the means of washing (B) 'whose' feet - possession
(C) the place of washing (D) direct address

51. Match the poetic name to its referent: रत्नाकरः points to:

- (A) the Himalaya (B) the farmers
(C) the novel (D) the ocean

52. Match the poetic name to its referent: पर्वतराजः points to:

- (A) the ocean (B) the crops
(C) the author (D) the Himalaya

53. Which pairing of word and meaning is CORRECT?

- (A) तीर्थक्षेत्राणि = ocean waves (B) सस्यश्यामला = snow-white
(C) पर्वतराजः = the sea (D) स्वेदबिन्दुभिः = with drops of sweat

54. The poem's praise of crops watered by farmers' sweat links the Motherland's beauty to:

- (A) the labour of her farmers (B) the wealth of foreign kings
(C) the size of her cities (D) the number of her novels

55. Which case would you use for the OBJECT that वन्दे salutes?

- (A) nominative (B) instrumental
(C) genitive (D) accusative

56. Which case is used for the MEANS 'with sweat-drops'?

- (A) instrumental (B) accusative
(C) genitive (D) vocative

57. Which case shows 'the Motherland's feet' (possession)?

- (A) instrumental (B) accusative
(C) genitive (D) nominative

58. A student writes वन्दे मातरम्, सस्यश्यामलाम् भारतमातरम्. Using the accusative मातरम्/भारतमातरम् here is:

- (A) wrong; they should be nominative (B) correct, since these are objects of वन्दे
(C) wrong; they should be genitive (D) wrong; वन्दे takes no object

59. Putting it together, which statement about वन्दे मातरम् is fully correct?

- (A) वन्दे = 'I love', author Tagore, novel मेघदूतम्
(B) वन्दे = 'I salute' (accusative object मातरम्), written by Bankim Chandra in the novel आनन्दमठः (1882)
(C) वन्दे takes a nominative object, and the author is unknown
(D) वन्दे = 'I see', from a 20th-century poem

60. A student claims: 'वन्दे माता means I love the mothers, and vowel length never matters.' The best correction is:

- (A) the student is fully correct (B) it should be वन्दे मातरः, and length matters
(C) वन्दे means love, but माता is correct
(D) it is वन्दे मातरम् = 'I salute the Mother' (accusative singular), and vowel length does change meaning

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 1: वन्दे भारतमातरम् (Vande Bharatamataram)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	C	21	D	31	D	41	D	51	D
2	A	12	B	22	A	32	C	42	C	52	D
3	D	13	A	23	A	33	A	43	B	53	D
4	C	14	C	24	B	34	C	44	B	54	A
5	C	15	B	25	D	35	B	45	A	55	D
6	D	16	C	26	A	36	C	46	C	56	A
7	B	17	A	27	D	37	C	47	D	57	C
8	B	18	B	28	A	38	D	48	A	58	B
9	B	19	A	29	D	39	A	49	A	59	B
10	C	20	B	30	B	40	C	50	B	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) वन्दे (root वन्द्, 'to salute') + मातरम् (accusative of मातृ) = 'I salute the Mother'. It is not 'the Mother loves me', a plural, or a vocative address.

2. (A) वन्दे (root वन्द्) means 'I salute, bow, praise' - reverence, not romantic love (कामये), seeing (दृश्), or giving (दा).

3. (D) वन्दे specifically means salutation/reverence; love has its own verbs like कामये/स्निह्यामि. It does not mean hate, is meaningful, and is distinct from love.

4. (C) वन्दे takes its object in the accusative, so मातृ becomes मातरम् (accusative singular). It is not the subject (nominative), possession (genitive), or address (vocative).

5. (C) The Mother is the object saluted, needing the accusative मातरम्; माता is nominative singular (the subject), not plural, and means 'mother', not 'ocean'.

6. (D) The chapter names बङ्किमचन्द्रः चट्टोपाध्यायः as the author. The children, Tagore and the farmers are not.

7. (B) The song appears in the novel आनन्दमठः. The others are different classical works.
8. (B) The chapter dates आनन्दमठः to 1882. 1947 is independence, 1950 the Constitution, and the 12th century far earlier.
9. (B) उपन्यासः means 'novel'. A song, mountain and ocean are different words.
10. (C) The children's जिज्ञासा (curiosity) leads the mother to explain the song. It is not an exam, a festival, or a farmer's request.
11. (C) जिज्ञासा is 'curiosity / desire to know'. Salutation is वन्दनम्, a novel उपन्यासः, and sweat स्वेदः.
12. (B) वन्दे मातरम् (accusative singular) is correct. माता is nominative singular, मातरः nominative plural, and मातृ the bare stem - all wrong here.
13. (A) मातरः is nominative plural; the song needs the accusative singular मातरम्. It is not the right accusative, a verb, or a genitive of 'ocean'.
14. (C) नमः and वन्दे take their object in the accusative (e.g. मातरम्). It is not nominative, vocative, or locative.
15. (B) माता is nominative singular; the object of वन्दे must be accusative (मातरम्). It is not already correct, plural, or a verb.
16. (C) मातृ becomes मातरम् in the accusative singular. माता is nominative singular, मातरः nominative plural, and मात्रा means 'measure/quantity'.
17. (A) पर्वतराजः ('king of mountains', पर्वतानां राजा) is the Himalaya. The ocean is रत्नाकरः, and farmers and holy places are different.
18. (B) पर्वतराजः = पर्वत ('mountain') + राजः ('king'), 'king of mountains'. The other splits are wrong.
19. (A) A crown sits on the head, so the Himalaya crowns Bharat at the top (north). The ocean, by contrast, washes her feet.
20. (B) पर्वतराजः is poetic praise titling the supreme mountain a 'king'. It is not an error, a tool, or the novel's name.
21. (D) रत्नाकरः ('mine of jewels') is a poetic name for the ocean (also समुद्रः). It is not the mountain, a tirtha, or a field.
22. (A) The ocean washes the Motherland's feet (भारतमातुः, genitive). Not the farmers', the children's, or the author's feet.

- 23. (A)** भारतमातुः is genitive, showing possession ('of the Motherland'). It is not accusative, instrumental, or vocative.
- 24. (B)** Crown at the head and ocean at the feet present Bharat as a revered mother honoured from head to foot. She is not a village, a farmer, or foreign.
- 25. (D)** तीर्थक्षेत्राणि are holy places / pilgrimage sites. They are not waves, peaks, or novels.
- 26. (A)** Naming holy places highlights Bharat's sacredness. It does not suggest poverty, small size, or an absence of rivers.
- 27. (D)** सस्यश्यामला means 'green/dark with crops'. It is not snow-white, desert-dry, or sea-blue.
- 28. (A)** सस्य ('crops') + श्यामला ('dark/green') = green with crops. The other splits are wrong.
- 29. (D)** सस्यश्यामला praises Bharat's fertile farmland. It is not about deserts, frozen mountains, or empty seas.
- 30. (B)** कृषकबान्धवाः are the farmers ('farmer-brethren'). They are not soldiers, kings, or merchants.
- 31. (D)** The farmers water the soil with their own sweat-drops (स्वेदबिन्दुभिः). Not merely rain, ocean water, or snow.
- 32. (C)** स्वेदबिन्दुभिः is instrumental plural, the means 'with sweat-drops'. It is not accusative, genitive, or nominative.
- 33. (A)** The instrumental -भिः means 'with / by means of'. 'To/for' is dative, 'of' genitive, and 'O...!' vocative.
- 34. (C)** The poem honours farmers' hard work in watering the land with sweat. Not traders, rulers, or the ocean alone.
- 35. (B)** देशभक्तः = देश ('country') + भक्तः ('devoted'), 'patriot'. Devotion to duty is धर्मभक्तः; a farmer and a novelist are different.
- 36. (C)** Both end in भक्तः ('devoted'); the first member shows what the devotion is to - देश (country) vs धर्म (duty). The shared part is भक्तः.
- 37. (C)** धर्मभक्तः is devoted to धर्म (duty/righteousness). Devotion to country is देशभक्तः; ocean and farming are unrelated.
- 38. (D)** Compounds reveal their meaning when split carefully into members (देश + भक्तः). Ignoring a member, guessing, or reading backwards does not work.

- 39. (A)** Vowel length matters in Sanskrit: आनन्द ('bliss') depends on the long आ. Long and short are not the same, Sanskrit has long vowels, and आ (two matras) is longer than अ.
- 40. (C)** आ is दीर्घ (long, two matras) and अ is ह्रस्व (short, one matra). The other pairings are wrong.
- 41. (D)** Since आनन्द ('bliss') depends on the long आ, mispronouncing it can change or break the meaning. Length does matter; it does not make the word plural or a verb.
- 42. (C)** Vowel quantity (मात्रा) is the subject of Chapter 13. Chapter 14 covers noun declension and Chapter 15 verb conjugation.
- 43. (B)** वन्दे comes from the root वन्द् ('to salute/praise'). कम्/कामये is 'to love', दृश् 'to see', गम् 'to go'.
- 44. (B)** वन्दे is first-person singular, 'I salute'. It is not third plural, second singular, or first plural.
- 45. (A)** Love is कामये/स्निह्यामि; वन्दे means salute, नमः 'salutation', and सिञ्चन्ति 'they water'.
- 46. (C)** It means 'I salute the Mother (Motherland)'. It is not 'mothers salute me', a vocative call, or 'I sell'.
- 47. (D)** Bharat is portrayed as a loving mother to be revered. She is not an enemy, a farmer, or a foreign queen.
- 48. (A)** The poem uses the Himalaya-crown, ocean-feet and crop-green-fields images. Not skyscrapers, deserts, or foreign armies.
- 49. (A)** The theme is loving reverence for the Motherland and her natural beauty. It is not cooking, trade, or only grammar.
- 50. (B)** भारतमातुः (genitive) answers 'whose feet' - possession. Not the means (instrumental), place (locative), or address (vocative).
- 51. (D)** रत्नाकरः ('mine of jewels') is the ocean. The Himalaya is पर्वतराजः; farmers and the novel are different.
- 52. (D)** पर्वतराजः ('king of mountains') is the Himalaya. The ocean is रत्नाकरः; crops and the author are different.
- 53. (D)** स्वेदबिन्दुभिः = 'with sweat-drops'. तीर्थक्षेत्राणि are holy places, सस्यश्यामला is crop-green, and पर्वतराजः is the Himalaya.
- 54. (A)** Crops watered by sweat tie Bharat's beauty to her farmers' labour. Not foreign wealth, city size, or novels.

55. (D) वन्दे's object takes the accusative (मातरम्). Not nominative (subject), instrumental (means), or genitive (possession).

56. (A) 'With sweat-drops' uses the instrumental (स्वेदबिन्दुभिः). Not accusative, genitive, or vocative.

57. (C) Possession ('the Motherland's') uses the genitive (भारतमातुः). Not instrumental, accusative, or nominative.

58. (B) As objects of वन्दे, they correctly take the accusative. They should not be nominative or genitive, and वन्दे does take an object.

59. (B) वन्दे = 'I salute' with the accusative object मातरम्, by Bankim Chandra in आनन्दमठः (1882). The others err on meaning, author, novel, case, or date.

60. (D) The correct form is वन्दे मातरम् ('I salute the Mother', accusative singular), and vowel length (ह्रस्व/दीर्घ) does matter. The other options keep one or more errors.